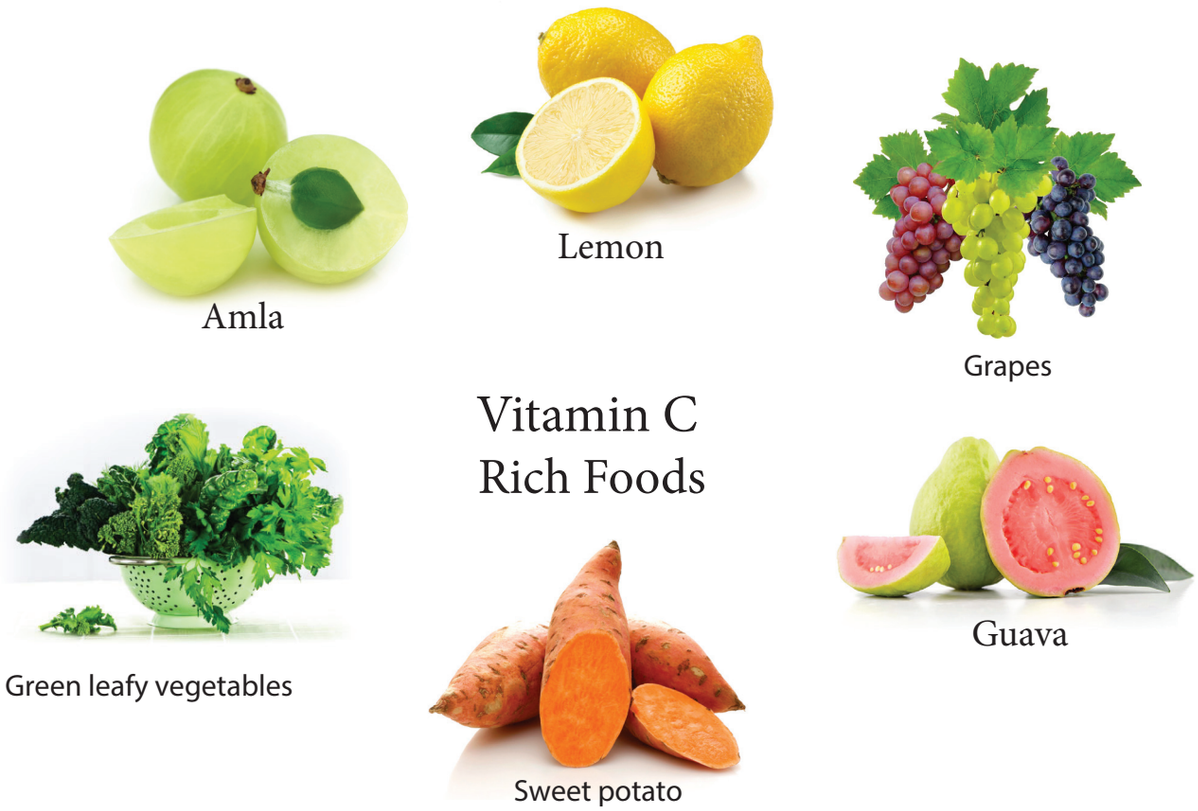


Fig 11.18: Food Sources of Vitamin C

Food Sources of Vitamin C: Amla, kiwi, strawberry, raspberry, grapes, berries, guava, citrus fruits like sweet lime, lemon, oranges, green leafy vegetables, spinach, hot chillies, turnip greens, broccoli, red bell pepper, tomato juice, raw tomato, sweet potato etc.,

Symptoms of Vitamin C deficiency

- Gums swell and bleed and become purple and spongy. This is known as pyorrhoea. Foul smell emits from the mouth.
- Deficiency can lead to scurvy in which a slight injury produces excessive bleeding and large hemorrhages are seen under the skin.
- There is tenderness, swelling and pain in the limbs.
- Reduced immunity causes simple infections like common cold, flu-viral, etc.,
- Irritability, aneamia, poor wound healing and Diarrhoea.
- Gastrointestinal discomfort.
- Weight loss, fatigue and joint pain.

11.4 Minerals

The body contains about 24 minerals, all of which must be provided by the diet. These are required by the body in very minute amounts and are often referred to as trace elements. The important ones are iron, iodine, calcium, zinc and sodium.

11.4.1 Iron

Iron was first recognized as a constituent of the body by Lernery in 1713. It is now known that all the iron in the body exists in combination with protein molecules.

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